

Scene 3: Goblin Ambush on the Trading Road

TIME

~15 minutes

PURPOSE

- First combat encounter
- Teach combat mechanics
- Teach observation and choices
- First loot drops

SETTING

Trading road narrows, forest presses close on both sides. Late afternoon shadows growing longer. Good place for an ambush.

THE SETUP

3-4 GOBLIN SCOUTS hiding in bushes alongside road, watching for merchants to rob. Not loyal to Dorogh - just opportunistic bandits. Cowardly - will flee if losing.

THE WARNING: Blade-bearer feels Blade grow cold (not ice-cold, just chill). Danger is near.

NOTICING THE AMBUSH

Players can spot goblins before attack:

- Blade-bearer: 'You feel the cold intensify near dense brush. Something hostile there.'
- Insight ability: Roll above 10 to sense hostile intent
- Wit ability: Roll above 10 to spot movement/weapons
- Creation ability: Roll above 10 to sense disturbed nature

IF PLAYERS SPOT THEM FIRST

OPTIONS:

1. Avoid entirely (Agility to move quietly - bypass encounter)
2. Ambush the ambushers (surprise - first attack succeeds automatically)
3. Call out (might negotiate or intimidate them into leaving)
4. Prepare defenses (normal combat but not surprised)

IF PLAYERS DON'T NOTICE

Suddenly, crude arrows whistle from bushes! Cackling laughter erupts as four goblins burst onto road, waving rusty blades.

Lead Goblin:

Your coin or your lives, travelers! Drop your packs and run, or we'll take EVERYTHING!

STILL CAN TRY TO TALK

- Heart: 'We don't want to fight you!'
- Wit: 'There are six of us, four of you - bad odds!'
- Offer something (Honeycake?) - goblins might take it and leave
- Or they get greedy and attack anyway

COMBAT - TEACHING MECHANICS

Use 3 goblins for small party, 4 for larger party

ENEMY TRACKING:

Goblin 1: HP: ☐

Goblin 2: HP: ☐

Goblin 3: HP: ☐

Goblin 4 (optional): HP: ☐

GOBLIN STATS

Defense Threshold: 12 (players roll above 12 to hit)

Attack Threshold: 6 (goblins roll above 6 to hit)

HP: 1 (one hit and down)

No armor, no resistances

TEACHING COMBAT STEP-BY-STEP

ROUND 1 - PLAYER ATTACKS:

1. 'Who wants to attack first? What weapon/ability?'
 2. 'Roll your d20'
 3. 'Roll your 2d6 for [ability] and pick higher one'
 4. 'Add them together. What's your total?'
 5. 'Need above 12 to hit. Did you make it?'
- YES: 'Your blade strikes true! Goblin yelps and falls!'
 - NO: 'Goblin dodges! Who's next?'

ROUND 2 - GOBLIN ATTACKS:

'The goblin swings at [player]. Rolling... [d20]. Need above 6.'

- IF HIT: 'Rusty blade catches you! Flip one ability face-down (your choice). That ability can't be used rest of battle.'
- IF MISS: 'You dodge out of the way!'

Continue teaching: different abilities, items, teamwork, Blade-bearer's 2 damage

GOBLIN BEHAVIOR

- When 2+ defeated, remaining might flee
- 'Last goblin's eyes go wide. Drops weapon and runs screaming!'
- Players can chase or let go (mercy moment)
- If goblins winning: GM can adjust difficulty on fly

AFTER COMBAT

VICTORY: 'The goblins are defeated! Road is clear.'

LOOT: 'You can search goblins. Roll to see if you find anything.'

- Each goblin: Roll d20, if 14+, draw 1 Item card
- Teaches loot mechanic

HEALING/RECOVERY: 'Battle is over. Flip all abilities and armor face-up - everything restored.'

BLADE MOMENT: 'The Blade warms in your hand again. Danger has passed.'

Optional quick discussion: 'How did that feel? What worked well?'

TRANSITION

The way is clear now. Rjocht looms ahead - you can see its walls in the distance, dark against the sky. The Blade grows colder with each step forward.